Long-Term Cycle Playbook

The models long-term holders watch, a one-page cycle checklist, and how HODLers use the readings to plan macro entries and exits with rules set in advance. Education only.

Power Law · 200-week MA · Mayer Multiple · MVRV proxy · Pi Cycle · Halving clock

Today's read

BTC daily close Oct 19, 2026

BTC	COMPOSITE	200-WEEK MA	HALVING CLOCK
$81,953	Mid-range	$67,071	912 days
-34% from ATH $124,720	score -0.33 (−1 cool … +1 hot)	price 1.22x	since Apr 20, 2024 · next ~Apr 2028

The models

ratio today · percentile vs all prior history · zone

MODEL	RATIO	PERCENTILE	ZONE
Power Law Price vs the long-run log-log trend line.	0.52x	12th	Historically cool
200-week MA Price vs its 200-week (about 4-year) average.	1.22x	26th	Historically cool
Mayer Multiple Price vs its 200-day average.	1.13x	52th	Mid-range
MVRV proxy Price vs its 2-year average, a stand-in for realized price.	0.92x	27th	Historically cool
Pi Cycle 111-day average vs 2x the 350-day average. A cross has marked past cycle peaks.	0.48x	—	Mid-range
Stock-to-Flow (shown, not in composite) Price vs PlanB's scarcity model.	0.05x	11th	Historically cool

Same definitions and math as the Desk's Model Zones and Members tools. Each ratio is ranked only against the days before it (no hindsight). Composite = equal-weight average of the scores, 7-day smoothed; cool ≤ −0.34, hot ≥ +0.34. Power Law trend today $156,830; 200-day average $72,569. MVRV here is a proxy (price ÷ 2-year average).

What the cycle has looked like

past halvings and peaks (daily closes)

HALVING	DATE	NEXT CYCLE PEAK	MONTHS AFTER HALVING
1st	Nov 28, 2012	Dec 2013	~12
2nd	Jul 9, 2016	Dec 2017	~17
3rd	May 11, 2020	Nov 2021	~18
4th	Apr 20, 2024	Oct 2025 (ATH so far)	~18

Three cycles are a small sample, and each was different. Use timing as context, never as a schedule.

The cycle checklist `run it monthly; tick what is true`

Signs of a historically cool market

- ☐ Price near or below the 200-week MA
- ☐ Power Law ratio under ~0.6x (lower part of its band)
- ☐ Mayer Multiple under 1.0 (below the 200-day average)
- ☐ MVRV proxy under 1.0 (below the 2-year average)
- ☐ Composite in the cool zone for several weeks
- ☐ Treasury-company premiums (mNAV) compressed near 1x or below
- ☐ Headlines bored or hostile; ETF outflows

Signs of a historically hot market

- ☐ Price 2.5x+ the 200-week MA
- ☐ Power Law ratio above ~1.5x
- ☐ Mayer Multiple above 2.0
- ☐ Pi Cycle 111-day average near 2x the 350-day
- ☐ Composite in the hot zone for several weeks
- ☐ mNAV premiums stretched across many treasury stocks
- ☐ 12–18 months after a halving; euphoric headlines

How long-term holders use it `common approaches, not recommendations`

1 · Baseline

Most HODLers keep a steady schedule (weekly or monthly) no matter the zone. The models only tilt the plan; they never replace it.

2 · Cool-zone tilt

Some raise contributions while the composite is cool, for example 1.5–2x the baseline, capped by a monthly budget written down in advance.

3 · Hot-zone plan

Holders with an exit goal set scale-out steps before euphoria, e.g. small slices only when several hot signals agree, keeping a core they never touch.

4 · Rules first

Write the rules while calm: thresholds, sizes and maximums. Then follow them. Most damage comes from changing the plan mid-cycle.

5 · No leverage

Cycles include 70%+ drawdowns. Plans that survive avoid margin and forced selling, and keep living costs outside BTC.

6 · Review, don't react

Check the read monthly, not hourly. A zone change is a prompt to review your written plan, not a signal to act.

Your plan `fill in`

Baseline contribution	_____ every _____
Cool-zone tilt (max per month)	_____
Hot-zone scale-out steps	_____
Core I never sell	_____ ₿
Review date each month	_____

Build and test these rules with the Desk's Entry & Exit Planner and Freedom Plan (Members, free). Models describe history; they do not predict. Education only, not investment advice.